discuss what would become of Palestine. The answer they provided was that a Government of All-Palestine would be created, based in the city of Gaza. As the name implied, this new government would rule all of Palestine, which would make it very difficult for King Abdullah to incorporate any parts of Palestine into Jordan. For the plan to work, of course, Israel would first have to be defeated.

On September 16, Count Bernadotte produced another plan that he hoped might solve the problems in Palestine. In some ways, it was similar to the first plan, but it abandoned the idea of a union and instead proposed two independent states. The plan also suggested that the UN would take control of Jewish immigration to Israel. The following day, gunmen ambushed Bernadotte's car while he was visiting Jerusalem. He and a French UN observer, André Serot, both died as the car came under machinegun fire. It was claimed that members of Lehi, afraid that the government of Israel might be considering accepting the terms of the plan proposed by Bernadotte, carried out the assassination. In the end, Bernadotte's new plan gained little support from either side.

During the truce, there were still isolated pockets of fighting. In particular, Arab militia members in an area south of the port of Haifa (known as the Little Triangle) began shooting at Israeli traffic using the road between Haifa and Tel Aviv. For Israel, this was a vital route that allowed the transport of supplies and personnel arriving at Haifa to reach the IDF. In response, the IDF launched Operation Shoter on July 24 (even while the second truce was in effect). It involved a full-scale assault on the villages in the Little Triangle with armor and artillery support. After a stubborn defense, the Arab villages surrendered on July 26. Residents were forcibly evicted, and some claimed that the IDF had massacred civilians, though a UN investigation found no evidence to support this claim.

As this was happening, Israeli politicians planned the next phase of the war. Part of the problem for the IDF was that it did not have sufficient forces to attack all four Arab armies simultaneously. Fortunately for them, the growing disunity between the Arab allies, particularly the growing rivalry between Egypt and Jordan as well as between the armed forces of Iraq and Jordan, seemed to offer a solution. If the IDF focused its forces on one Arab army at a time and planned these in such a way that other Arab armies would not intervene, then it might be possible to defeat each separately.